



Keys should not be too hard or too soft to press and their rebound should also be nominal — this is termed as good feedback



Extra mouse buttons enable you to do common tasks quickly and without using shortcut keys

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and zoom buttons are to the left of the main keys while three flat-button shortcut keys have been provided at the bottom right of the unit. The alphabet keys themselves are very well laid out and this together with the slight bevelling on the top makes typing a real joy. The key spacing is greater than on a regular keyboard, but similar to the key spacing on the Logitech G15, which, strangely, is a gaming keyboard. This said we had no issues adapting to the slightly more spaced-out layout.

The feedback of the keys also seemed a little soft at first, but within a few hours of use we realised that this is noticeably less stressful on the fingers. However, the feedback isn't as squishy as we've found some Microsoft keyboards to be. In fact, a light, almost whisper-like, touch is all that's needed to type and our typing speed actually went up on this keyboard, which is about as good a praise as one can imagine. The palm rest is adequate, but we'd prefer one that extends just a little bit more; for us this palm rest is a little short to be termed properly ergonomic; the Logitech G15 has a slightly larger surface area on its palm rest although there is always a trade-off with workspace area. Unlike the MX 3200, its surface is not coated with any bacteria-resistant material and we noticed the palm rest does not get sweaty, even with prolonged use sans air conditioning. One annoying feature we found when using this keyboard was that the function keys have been split apart by the word *Logitech* and its monogram, therefore there is a two inch gap between the [F8] and [F9] keys. That being said, each of the function keys has an alternate function highlighted in orange. Corresponding to this orange colour scheme there's a function key that replaces the right-side Windows key and using this key allows the alternate functionality to be accessed.

The keyboard has a small display embedded into the top, and this portion is tapered so that this display is convenient to read when looking down at the keyboard. This display will show you the status of any of the shortcut keys currently being used; otherwise it can be programmed to display the time and date. For example, if you change

the sound volume, a level indicator will be displayed. It also works with the *calculator* function in which case both operations and results are displayed. Do note that this LCD is not backlit, which means it will not be readable in dimly lit conditions; although if it were backlit it would drain a lot more battery juice — any sort of backlighting is a double-edged sword when it comes to wireless keyboards. The MX 5500 uses four AA batteries, which is two batteries more than the MX 3200 used. Logitech claims battery life at a whopping six months and while we had no way to test this, we used this keyboard for three weeks with heavy usage and had no issues at all.

The MX Revolution is no longer new, having being launched some time in 2006. But it's still one of the most advanced (read designed for extreme office users) mice around. It follows the same black/dark grey colour scheme as the VX Nano, but it's



shaped radically different and is much larger and heavier. The scroll wheel has the ability to work as a free spinning (quick) scroll or a click-like (precision) scroll function. Toggling between these functions happens by pressing the mouse wheel but this is not a mechanical function as it is in the VX Nano; instead, the switching is electronic, and for this reason the toggle does not work unless the Bluetooth dongle is connected to a computer. The built-in tilt-wheel functionality is a huge plus for those working with spreadsheets. This mouse is designed for right-handed folk and the thumb region is deeply recessed, with the body below the thumb tapering outwards sharply; this creates a wide base for

the mouse to sit on and also a proper resting area for your thumb. In fact it reminds us of sports bikes' wind-cheating bodywork in the way one's thumb completely fits into this recess. The right side is lightly sculpted for your last two fingers. The forward/backward buttons are located conveniently above the thumb recess and while they are easily accessible with the pad of the thumb, they are well out of reach to be accidentally or unintentionally used. With Logitech's drivers installed the mouse wheel is actually pretty smart and can be configured to run in either precision mode or speed mode, according to the application.

Located within the thumb recess is another mouse wheel — the document flip. This one has limited movement both ways. Clicking the wheel brings up a window with all current programs running being shown as smaller windows. Nudge the wheel and you'll start flipping through the documents. Once you get used to it, this is a faster, neater version of Windows' alt + tab. A dedicated search button is also provided, located behind the main mouse wheel; this provides instant online searching of a highlighted word or phrase.

Using the MX Revolution for browsing and working with spreadsheets and documents is a joy. The mouse tracks fairly accurately, although an MX 518 it is not, therefore don't expect a lot of frag-fest wins with this mouse. Another plus is the sealed lithium-ion battery and the battery lasts for around 15 days on a single charge. A neat dock has been provided for effortless charging when it's needed and the four-stage, green-LED battery indicator on the mouse body will notify you when the device needs juice. On a slightly negative note the MX revolution is heavy, understandably so considering the functionality it packs and its largish size. Despite the fact that most mice with a pair of AA batteries would be heavier we'd like it to be around 25 grams lighter.

As a combination of keyboard and mouse the MX 5500 Revolution is hard to beat. Although it doesn't have the (ahem) split keyboard layout that is touted as being "really" ergonomic, we feel this is about as

Staples 13392, Pneumatic Fabric Manager Chair: Grey suit

The Pneumatic Fabric Manager Chair is really not that great to look at. The chair is broader at the shoulder level and tapers slightly towards the base. The back rest ends at the neck and there is no head support. The fabric of this chair is made of a microsuede fabric and the colour of this chair is a dark bluish-grey.

This chair is not too soft but you can easily get used to sitting in it. There is also extra cushioning towards the base which gives good lower back support. Along with that some extra cushioning towards the top of the chair gives good shoulder and upper back support while sitting upright.

You can easily adjust the height of this chair. A tilt lock is also present on this chair, but the chair can only be locked in the upright position.

One interesting feature is the adjustable side arm



handles which can be adjusted by a simple clip along with a pull-push mechanism located on the handles itself. Though this is a very useful feature to have in a chair, the model that we received had very wobbly side handles, which is not comfortable at all. Also these handles do not have any fabric on them, instead is made of rubber which is found on many computer chairs.

This chair would not suit a person who has to sit and type all day. It is more likely to be suited for a manager of a company who doesn't need to type very much or even someone who spends the whole day in meetings in a board room. But a price tag of Rs. 9,990 (MRP), does not justify the features that this chair offers. It is much more of a comfortable meeting chair than an ergonomic computer seat.